AGNOLOTTI DAL PLIN WITH BRISKET AND CARAMELIZED ONION

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**6-8**	**8 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

27 g	Salt
912 g	Brisket, center cut with a moderate amount of fat
56 g	Olive oil
1.85 kg	Onions, cut into 1/8-inch slices
2 sprigs	Thyme
474 g	Water
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano for the filling, finely grated
quantity not given	Nutmeg, whole
1 batch	Egg dough
85 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano to finish, finely grated

METHOD

1. Salt the brisket on every side. Give it an hour at minimum to take the salt up, or refrigerate it as long as 24 hours. Bring it back to room temperature before cooking.
2. Heat the oven to 275°F.
3. Pat the brisket dry. Warm 42 g of the oil in a large saute pan over medium heat and sear the brisket fat side down 4 to 5 minutes, until the fat begins to melt and goes golden brown. Sear the other sides 4 to 5 minutes each, turning as needed, then transfer it to a sheet pan.
4. Spread half the onions over the base of a heavy lidded saucepot or Dutch oven. Set the brisket on them, pile the rest of the onions over it, and lay the thyme on top. Pour in the water, seal the pot with foil or parchment, and clamp the lid down over the seal.
5. Cook 5 to 6 hours, until the meat pulls apart easily under a fork. By then the onions will have collapsed and caramelized into a jus.
6. While that cooks, chill the meat grinder and its small die in the refrigerator at least 1 hour, or 30 minutes in the freezer.
7. Take the pot out, uncover it, and spoon off whatever fat has risen to the surface. Leave the brisket in the pot about 20 minutes, until cool enough to handle.
8. Lift the brisket onto a sheet pan. Strain the cooking liquid, keeping solids and liquid separate and squeezing the onions hard. You should have 150 g of onions and 474 g of liquid. Set both aside.
9. Pick the meat into small pieces and discard the fat. Grind the meat through the small die, then grind the braised onions.
10. Combine the meat and onions in a bowl with the 30 g of parmigiano and the remaining 14 g of oil. Season with grated nutmeg and salt and mix well. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate.
11. Take the filling out about 30 minutes before you use it, because it is far easier to work at room temperature.
12. Make 160 to 180 agnolotti dal plin from the egg dough and the filling.
13. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to a boil over high heat.
14. Set a large saute pan on low heat. Put in the strained braising liquid with the butter and swirl them into a sauce. Hold it on low, swirling now and then.
15. Drop the agnolotti in and bring the water down to a gentle simmer rather than a rolling boil, which matters here. Cook 2 to 4 minutes. They are done when the thickest seal has gone tender.
16. Lift them into the saute pan with a spider or pasta basket and raise the heat to medium. Swirl 1 to 2 minutes, turning the pieces with a spoon, until the sauce has thickened to something close to gravy and hugs the pasta. A splash of pasta water loosens it if it tightens.
17. Divide into flat-bottomed bowls. Spoon the sauce left in the pan over the top and finish with the 22 g of parmigiano and grated nutmeg.

NOTES

The braise is both filling and sauce. Strained solids go inside the pasta, the 474 g of strained liquid becomes the sugo the agnolotti are finished in.
275°F under a sealed lid for 5 to 6 hours takes the meat through roasting, then steaming, then braising as the onions melt down.
Squeeze the onions hard when straining. Liquid left in them comes straight off the sauce.
Simmer, do not boil. Judge doneness at the thickest closure point.
160 to 180 pieces serves 6 to 8, which is 25 to 30 postage-stamp pockets a head. This is not a same-day dish.

FILLING

Brisket and Caramelized Onion Filling

INGREDIENTS

27 g	Salt
912 g	Brisket, center cut with a moderate amount of fat
56 g	Olive oil
1.85 kg	Onions, cut into 1/8-inch slices
2 sprigs	Thyme
474 g	Water
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Nutmeg, whole

METHOD

1. Salt the brisket all over. Give it an hour at minimum to take the salt up, or refrigerate it as long as 24 hours. Bring it back to room temperature before it goes near heat.
2. Heat the oven to 275°F.
3. Pat the brisket dry to take off any surface moisture. Warm 42 g of the oil in a large saute pan over medium heat and sear the brisket fat side down 4 to 5 minutes, until the fat starts to melt and turns golden brown. Sear the remaining sides 4 to 5 minutes each, turning as needed, then move it to a sheet pan.
4. Spread half the onions over the base of a heavy lidded saucepot or Dutch oven. Lay the brisket on them, pile the rest of the onions over the top, and lay the thyme on the onions. Pour in the water, seal the pot with foil or parchment, and clamp the lid down over the seal.
5. Cook 5 to 6 hours, until the meat pulls apart easily under a fork. By then the onions will have collapsed and caramelized into a jus, which becomes the base of the sauce.
6. While that happens, chill the meat grinder and its small die in the refrigerator at least 1 hour, or 30 minutes in the freezer.
7. Take the pot out, uncover it, and spoon off whatever fat has risen. Leave the brisket in the pot about 20 minutes, until it is cool enough to handle.
8. Lift the brisket onto a sheet pan. Strain the cooking liquid, keeping the solids and the liquid separate and squeezing the onions hard so none of the liquid stays behind. You should end up with 150 g of onions and 474 g of liquid. Set both aside.
9. Pick the meat into small pieces and discard the fat. Grind the meat through the small die, then grind the braised onions.
10. Combine the meat and onions in a bowl with the parmigiano and the remaining 14 g of oil. Season with grated nutmeg and salt and mix well. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate.
11. Take the filling out of the refrigerator about 30 minutes before you use it. It handles much better at room temperature.

NOTES

The braise yields two things. The strained solids become the filling and the 474 g of strained liquid becomes the sauce, so do not discard either.
275°F for 5 to 6 hours under a sealed lid cooks the meat in three stages in sequence, roasting first, then steaming, then braising as the onions melt.
Squeeze the onions hard at the straining step. Liquid left in them is volume taken off the sauce.
Cold filling is stiff and tears pasta sheets. The 30 minutes at room temperature is worth waiting for.
1.85 kg of onion to 912 g of brisket looks wrong and is not. The onion is the sweetness in both the filling and the sauce.

SHAPE

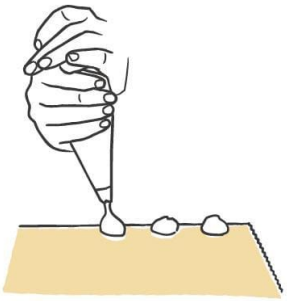
Agnolotti dal Plin

Region: Piedmont, the Langhe and Monferrato / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

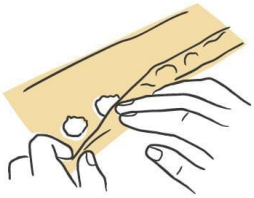
METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet lengthwise. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1/4-inch opening, pipe hazelnut-sized beads of filling 1/2 inch in from the bottom edge, spaced about 1 inch apart. With a dense filling such as meat, pinch off each portion and place it by hand instead.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Fold the bottom edge up and over the beads so the dough hugs them, and press the top edge down onto the sheet beneath.
7. Pinch the dough closed on both sides of every bead with thumb and index finger, then go back over each pinch to confirm the seal.
8. Run a fluted pastry cutter along the seam where the top edge meets the sheet, shaving the empty pasta away as tight to that seam as possible. Pull off the leftover strip and save it for another row.
9. With the same cutter, cut between the pieces, centering each cut on a pinch. Each piece rolls over onto itself into an envelope as it separates.
10. Move the pieces to the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
11. Repeat with the rest of that sheet, then with the remaining sheets.
12. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

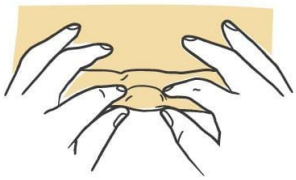
SHAPING



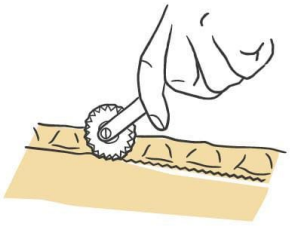
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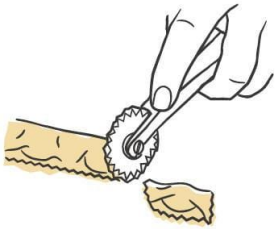
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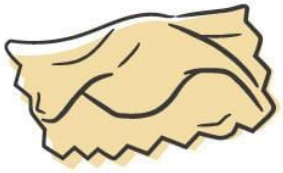
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NOTES

Sheets are trimmed to 18 inches long. Each finished piece is about the size of a postage stamp, and a single serving runs 25 to 30 of them.
Filling per piece: one hazelnut-sized bead, piped through a 1/4-inch opening (half the opening used for the full-size agnolotti).
Spacing: beads sit 1/2 inch from the bottom edge and 1 inch apart. That 1-inch interval is the pinch interval and sets the finished size.
Each bead is piped separately rather than as one continuous rope. Individual beads give a cleaner cut and a better closure, which matters with a meat filling that would otherwise burst when you cut through it. A continuous line works with a looser filling such as sunchoke.
Cutter: fluted pastry cutter, for both the seam trim and the separating cuts.
Seal geometry: pinch on both sides of every bead, trim the seam, then cut through the center of each pinch so the piece folds itself into an envelope. The pinch is what the name refers to.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Classically finished in a pan sauce of butter and the juices from roasted meat. The shape also suits fillings that do not need volume to register, such as sunchoke or fonduta.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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